CHAPTER 4
Tragedy

In the late spring of 1631, Shah Jahan went to war against the governor of one of the provinces. The governor had started a rebellion. The battlefield was in an area called the Deccan plain, in the south. As always, Mumtaz traveled with her husband, although she was expecting their fourteenth child.

Weather in the Deccan is usually very hot. Temperatures often rise over 100 degrees Fahrenheit. The land there is dusty and dry. When Mumtaz was about to give birth, she moved to a fortress overlooking a river. The air would be cooler there. She and the baby would be safe.

On June 16, Shah Jahan's troops won a victory. Joyfully, he went to the fortress to tell his wife the good news.